

Many recognize it only when they are in college or a couple of years after earning. Some of us live our lives without ever knowing what we wish to 'become' and tend to 'go with the flow' .

The harsh reality is that very few of us know what we want to do early enough so that we can get into the right degree and graduate with enough distinction to start a career right. Most of us either need time to 'find ourselves' or money to help follow our passions. A salaried job, even if it entails drudgery, provides a solid base to introspect - recognize what would make us happy, save up enough to fund our dreams, or stop working altogether (aka early retirement).

With anything in life, the grass always looks greener on the other side. Working in a corporate role, we tend to think that entrepreneurs are lucky as they decide what they work on and are their own boss. Entrepreneurs would like the assured income of a corporate employee because uncertainty is rampant. For both, there's one entity that they value more: time.

In search of time

"Like Warren, I had a considerable passion to get rich, not because I wanted Ferraris – I wanted the independence. I desperately wanted it."

- Charlie Munger, Warren Buffett's right hand man

In most instances, corporate employees like to have time to do 2 things: either pursue entrepreneurial ambitions with enough parachute or just retire early and travel. We'll look at both the cases and see how much runway we'd need to do either.

Case 1: I want to start something on my own

The human desire to dream, create, innovate, break free from the established rules, wonder about how nature works and find new ways to get things done cannot be extinguished. Not by our school system which demands conformity, not by a corporate behemoth where individuality is undesirable and definitely not by financial insecurity.

For those who have a burning desire to become an entrepreneur, a salaried job is a stopgap arrangement - something that provides a means to build a moat around our dreams. When we want something badly enough, failure is